

FORENSIC ASSESSMENT REPORT

Windows Auto-Start Extensibility Points (ASEP) & Persistence Threat Analysis

Report ID:	FAR-02EDE00C	Scan Timestamp:	2026-10-03 19:09:58 UTC
Target Host:	Utkarsh	Operating System:	Windows 10 (10.0.22631)
Total ASEPs Analyzed:	493	Scan Duration:	17.28s
System Risk Score:	100/100 (CRITICAL)	Target User:	utkar

CRITICAL 4	HIGH 0	MEDIUM 314	LOW 112	CLEAN 63
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1. Executive Summary & Forensic Assessment

An in-depth automated digital forensic inspection of Windows Auto-Start Extensibility Points (ASEP) was executed on **Utkarsh**. A total of **493 startup mechanisms** were inspected across Registry Run keys, Winlogon, Image File Execution Options (IFEO), Active Setup, Startup Folders, Scheduled Tasks, Windows Services, WMI Event Subscriptions, and System Drivers.

The system received an overall Suspicion Risk Score of **100/100 (CRITICAL)**. **CRITICAL ATTENTION REQUIRED:** A total of **4 Critical** and **0 High-risk** persistent anomalies were identified that warrant immediate containment and remediation.

2. Critical & High-Risk Persistence Findings

The following items triggered high-confidence heuristic rule violations or MITRE ATT&CK; indicators:

Finding #1: Task: UninstallSMB1ClientTask | [CRITICAL - Score: 95/100]

Category:	Scheduled Task
Location:	Task Scheduler: \Microsoft\Windows\SMB\UninstallSMB1ClientTask
Command / Target:	%windir%\system32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe -ExecutionPolicy Unrestricted -NonInteractive -NoProfile -WindowStyle Hidden & %windir%\system32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\Modules\SmbShare\DisableUnusedSmb1.ps1 -Scenario Client""
Resolved Binary:	C:\WINDOWS\system32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe
Digital Signature:	Status: Valid Signer: Microsoft Windows
Cryptographic Hash & PE:	SHA256: 3247bcfd60f6dd25f34cb74b5889ab10ef1b3ec72b4d4b3d95b5b25b534560b8 Entropy: 5.3938/8.0
Triggered Rules:	[CRITICAL] Obfuscated Command: Hidden Window Execution: Command line utilizes stealth or obfuscation techniques: Hidden Window Execution in command string. [MEDIUM] Living-Off-The-Land Binary (powershell.exe): Startup persistence leverages native system utility 'powershell.exe' to proxy script or command execution. [MEDIUM] Timestomping Timestamp Anomaly: Timestomping anomaly: Ancient compile timestamp (1974-07-29 16:18:42 UTC)
Remediation:	Unregister-ScheduledTask -TaskName "\Microsoft\Windows\SMB\UninstallSMB1ClientTask" -Confirm:\$false -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue

Finding #2: Task: UninstallSMB1ServerTask | [CRITICAL - Score: 95/100]

Category:	Scheduled Task
Location:	Task Scheduler: \Microsoft\Windows\SMB\UninstallSMB1ServerTask
Command / Target:	%windir%\system32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe -ExecutionPolicy Unrestricted -NonInteractive -NoProfile -WindowStyle Hidden & %windir%\system32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\Modules\SmbShare\DisableUnusedSmb1.ps1 -Scenario Server""
Resolved Binary:	C:\WINDOWS\system32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe
Digital Signature:	Status: Valid Signer: Microsoft Windows
Cryptographic Hash & PE:	SHA256: 3247bcfd60f6dd25f34cb74b5889ab10ef1b3ec72b4d4b3d95b5b25b534560b8 Entropy: 5.3938/8.0
Triggered Rules:	[CRITICAL] Obfuscated Command: Hidden Window Execution: Command line utilizes stealth or obfuscation techniques: Hidden Window Execution in command string. [MEDIUM] Living-Off-The-Land Binary (powershell.exe): Startup persistence leverages native system utility 'powershell.exe' to proxy script or command execution. [MEDIUM] Timestomping Timestamp Anomaly: Timestomping anomaly: Ancient compile timestamp (1974-07-29 16:18:42 UTC)
Remediation:	Unregister-ScheduledTask -TaskName "\Microsoft\Windows\SMB\UninstallSMB1ServerTask" -Confirm:\$false -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue

Finding #3: Service: Intel® Graphics Software | [CRITICAL - Score: 85/100]

Category:	Windows Service
Location:	HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\IntelGraphicsSoftwareService
Command / Target:	"C:\Program Files\WindowsApps\AppUp.IntelArcSoftware_26.32.2604.0_x64__8j3eq9eme6ctt\VFS\ProgramFilesX64\Intel\Intel Graphics Software\IntelGraphicsSoftware.Service.exe"
Resolved Binary:	C:\Program Files\WindowsApps\AppUp.IntelArcSoftware_26.32.2604.0_x64__8j3eq9eme6ctt\VFS\ProgramFilesX64\Intel\Intel Graphics Software\IntelGraphicsSoftware.Service.exe
Digital Signature:	Status: NotSigned
Cryptographic Hash & PE:	SHA256: 07e2675f3fe54553948f499b844f2123bc2a369950edafe364b84c0312de6795 Entropy: 7.3166/8.0 (HIGH ENTROPY / PACKED)
Triggered Rules:	[HIGH] High Shannon Entropy (7.3166) / Packed Binary: File exhibits high Shannon entropy of 7.3166/8.0, characteristic of packed malware, crypters, or encrypted shellcode. [MEDIUM] Suspicious Injection / Memory APIs: Suspicious API imports detected: IsDebuggerPresent [HIGH] Corporate Metadata Impersonation: File claims CompanyName 'Intel Corporation' in metadata but lacks a valid digital signature from that entity.
Remediation:	Stop-Service -Name "IntelGraphicsSoftwareService" -Force -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue; Set-Service -Name "IntelGraphicsSoftwareService" -StartupType Disabled

Finding #4: Winlogon Shell | [CRITICAL - Score: 60/100]

Category:	Winlogon Persistence
Location:	HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon\Shell
Command / Target:	explorer.exe
Resolved Binary:	explorer.exe
Triggered Rules:	[CRITICAL] Critical System Process Masquerading: Binary is masquerading as legitimate Windows system file 'explorer.exe' but executes from unauthorized path 'explorer.exe'. [LOW] Orphaned Persistence Entry (Target Missing): Startup entry references non-existent target path 'explorer.exe'. May be residue of uninstalled app or cleaned malware.
Remediation:	Set-ItemProperty -Path "HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon" -Name "Shell" -Value "explorer.exe"

3. MITRE ATT&CK; Framework Mapping

Technique ID	Technique Name	Tactics	Observed Count
T1059.001	Command and Scripting Interpreter: PowerShell	Execution (TA0002)	2
T1218	System Binary Proxy Execution (LOLBins)	Defense Evasion (TA0005)	15
T1070.006	Indicator Removal: Timestamp	Defense Evasion (TA0005)	208
T1027.002	Software Packing / High Entropy Payload	Defense Evasion (TA0005)	1
T1055	Persistence & Execution Technique	Persistence (TA0003)	141
T1036.005	Masquerading: Match Legitimate Name or Location	Defense Evasion (TA0005)	2
T1547.001	Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder	Persistence (TA0003), Privilege Escalation (TA0004)	15

4. Recommended Remediation Action Plan

Step 1: Neutralize Persistence: Task: UninstallSMB1ClientTask

Execute remediation command to remove unauthorized persistence hook at 'Task Scheduler:

\Microsoft\Windows\SMB\UninstallSMB1ClientTask'.

```
Unregister-ScheduledTask -TaskName "\Microsoft\Windows\SMB\UninstallSMB1ClientTask" -Confirm:$false
-ErrorAction SilentlyContinue
```

Step 2: Neutralize Persistence: Task: UninstallSMB1ServerTask

Execute remediation command to remove unauthorized persistence hook at 'Task Scheduler:

\Microsoft\Windows\SMB\UninstallSMB1ServerTask'.

```
Unregister-ScheduledTask -TaskName "\Microsoft\Windows\SMB\UninstallSMB1ServerTask" -Confirm:$false
-ErrorAction SilentlyContinue
```

Step 3: Neutralize Persistence: Service: Intel® Graphics Software

Execute remediation command to remove unauthorized persistence hook at

'HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\IntelGraphicsSoftwareService'.

```
Stop-Service -Name "IntelGraphicsSoftwareService" -Force -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue; Set-Service -Name
"IntelGraphicsSoftwareService" -StartupType Disabled
```

Step 4: Neutralize Persistence: Winlogon Shell

Execute remediation command to remove unauthorized persistence hook at 'HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon\Shell'.

```
Set-ItemProperty -Path "HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon" -Name "Shell" -Value
"explorer.exe"
```